



# Otter Power-Ups

Discover Workflows for Effective Study Notes

# Outline

## Core Study Principles

Review three evidence-based study principles that enhance learning effectiveness.

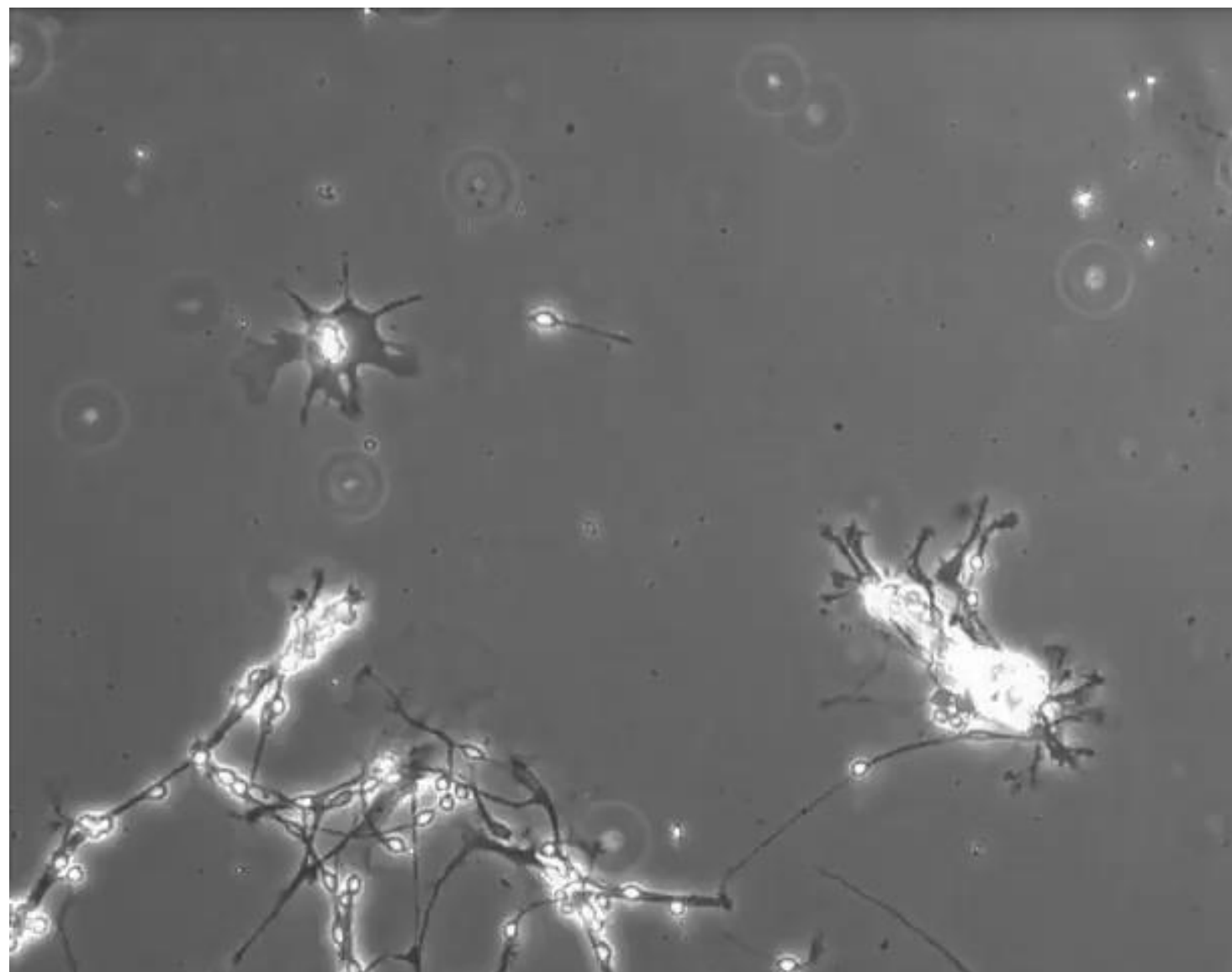
## Study Notes Workflow

Take Otter-generated summaries to the next level.

## Memory & Creativity

Recall memories to support creative thinking.







# Why Memorize?

## **Independent judgment**

Develop a reference point for new information.

## **Mastery**

Enhance your "offline" abilities.

## **Creativity**

Generate ideas from your new understanding.





# Evidence-Based Recommendations

## Effective Study Strategies

Well-structured notes, active recall, and spaced retrieval.

## Conceptual Memory

Understanding concepts and technical information.

## Creative Application

Engage existing memories to provide opportunity for novel recombination.



# Three Principles (+1)

## Structured Notes from Otter

Yay, you already have this!

### Active Engagement

Develop questions, test your own understanding, and apply your own experiences.

### Spaced Repetition

Periodic review depending on your level of mastery.



# +1

## **Breaks**

Step away to un-focus.

## **Restful activity**

Discover routines unrelated to study.

## **Sleep**

Regular maintenance.







# Otter Notes Power-Ups

## **Elaboration and Self-Explanation**

'Why?' and 'How?' prompts and teach back.

## **Dual Coding**

Adding icons and diagrams engages multiple senses to enhance memory.

## **Semantic and Episodic Markers**

Integrate factual concepts and personal experience for creativity.

## **Retrieval Practice**

Open-ended questions to encourage active recall.





# Memorization Guardrails

## Focus on Single Idea

Each flashcard should concentrate on one idea.

## Use Open Prompts

Open-ended questions beyond memorization.

## Limit New Insights

Focus on the most prominent concepts.

## Gradually Find your Own Words

Add personal insights as applicable to boost creative thinking.

# **Sample Workflow – Email Yourself**

## **Copy Notes from Otter**

Organize your Otter notes in a document

## **Pick and Choose**

Use the most relevant items to create "email flashcards" with relevant prompts

## **Schedule Send**

Accomplish spaced repetition by repeatedly scheduling delivery

## **Add Insights**

Review and enhance before setting up another scheduled delivery



# **Sample Workflow – Print or Digital Flashcards**

## **Hierarchical Flashcards**

Filter Otter summaries into tiers for comprehension.

## **Scale Up Over Time**

Start with key terms & concepts to lay the foundation.

## **Reverse Cards**

Move from recognition to recall.

## **Space It Out**

Set card order to see challenging items more often.

# Resources

- Barbara Oakley on Learning How To Learn (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vd2dtkMINlw>)
- ANKI App for Spaced Repetition (<https://docs.ankiweb.net/getting-started.html>)

